

Decision-making guide

Sales & Target

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1. Simulation platform introduction

1.1 Game Arena

The gaming arena interface comprises various decision tabs that includes introduction, market, information search, planning, composition, development, Decision Checklist, Report, and Synopsis. Some sections must be completed first as they have an impact on other areas.

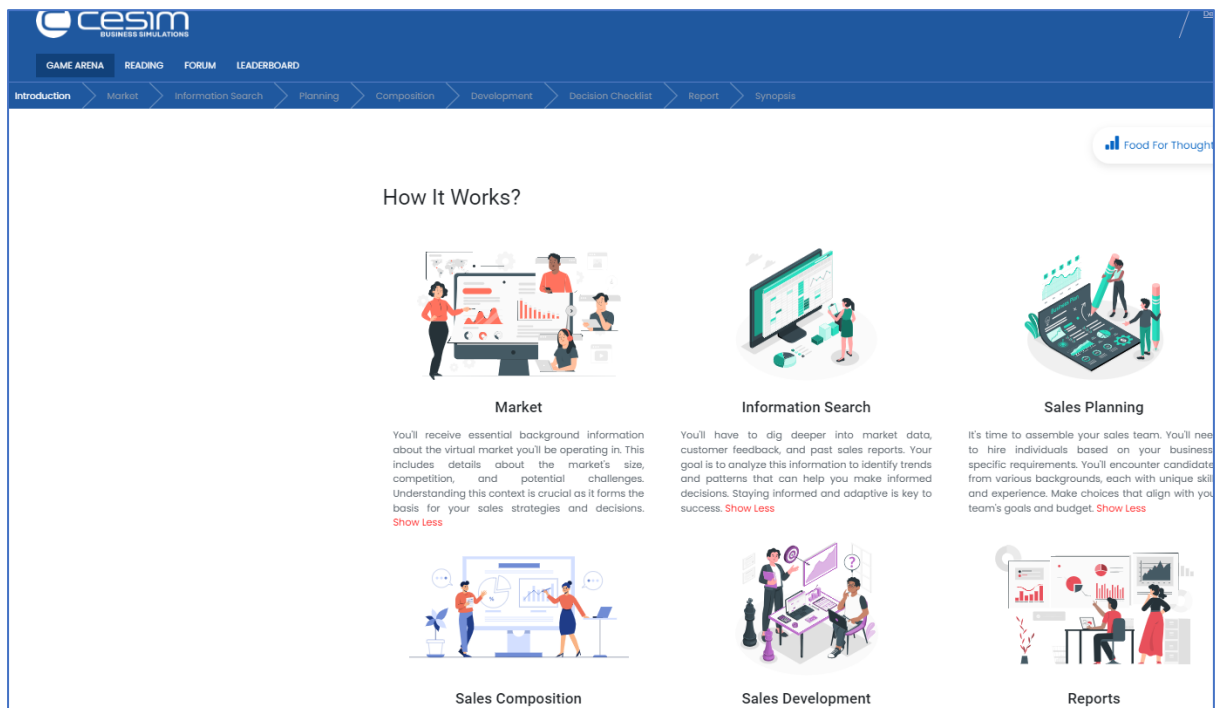


Figure 1 The Game arena

1.2 Readings

This section provides essential materials necessary for participants to actively engage in the simulation. The main reading material consists of a decision-making guide, supplemented by optional additional resources chosen by instructors. Additionally, a walkthrough video is accessible, providing insights into the case scenario and discussing various parameters to consider for making informed decisions in various tabs.

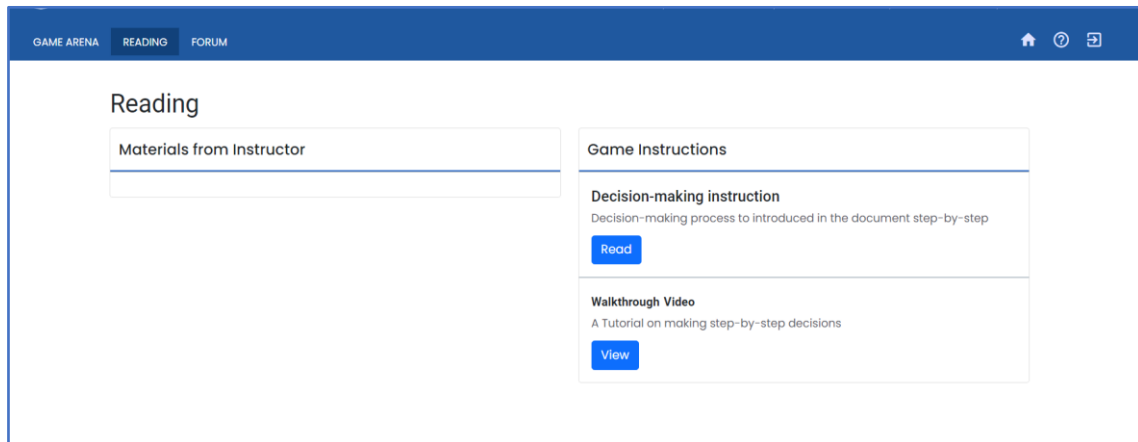


Figure 2 Reading Section in the platform

1.3 Forum

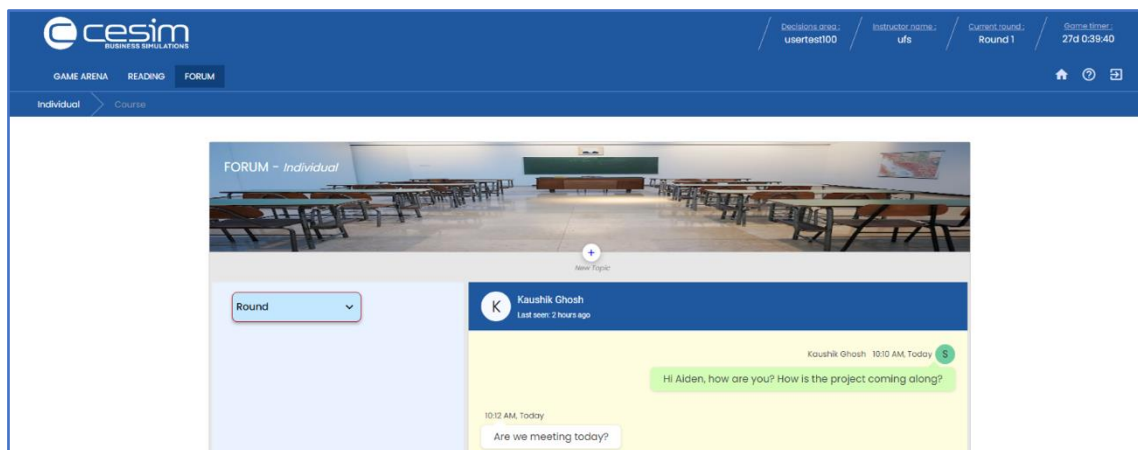


Figure 3 Forum Section in the platform

- The forums provide an excellent platform for participants to engage with their instructors or peers.
- There are two separate forums: the Individual Forum and the Course Forum. The Individual Forum allows participants to communicate directly with the instructor, while the Course Forum is accessible to all enrolled players.

- Instructors can view and respond to posts in both sections. Consequently, the Course Forum is an appropriate space for asking questions that can benefit the entire course, while the Individual Forum is the preferred channel for the individual to have a direct discussion with the professor.
- Participants will receive notifications for messages.

1.4 Leaderboard

The leaderboard section provides insight into your current position compared to other participants. Here, you can view your key performance indicators (KPIs) and where you stand in relation to others. This feature allows you to gauge your performance relative to your peers, offering valuable feedback and motivation to strive for improvement.

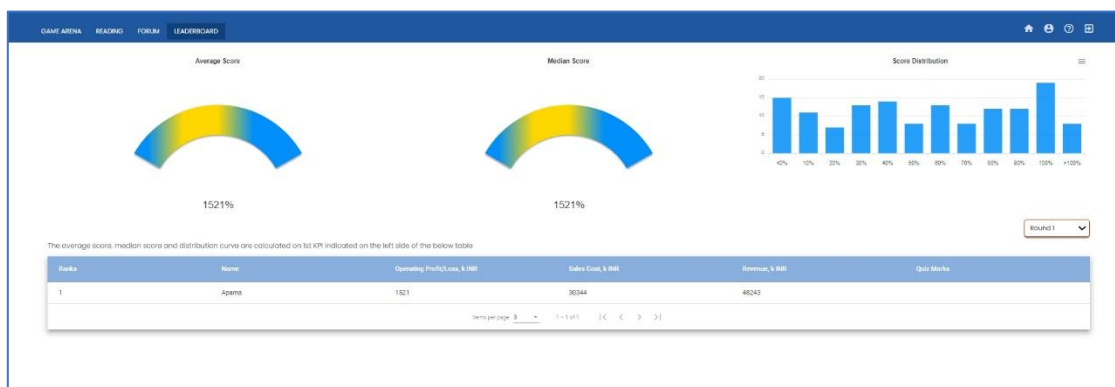


Figure 4 The leaderboard Section in the Platform

1.5 Main Objective & Winning Criteria

As the Sales Head at Pablo, Inc., your role involves leading and mentoring the sales team to execute strategies effectively, fostering the company's growth and success in a competitive market. By utilizing historical data, your responsibility is to refine strategies, strengthen Pablo, Inc.'s market position, and win over consumers while maintaining cost efficiency. Major tasks include planning the right number of sales personnel, determining their compensation, composing the sales team with the right sales styles, and deciding on methods to train and develop the team. The end goal is to improve the operating profit, and enhance overall channel sales effectiveness.

1.6 Successful decision-making flow

The sequence of decision-making unfolds as follows:

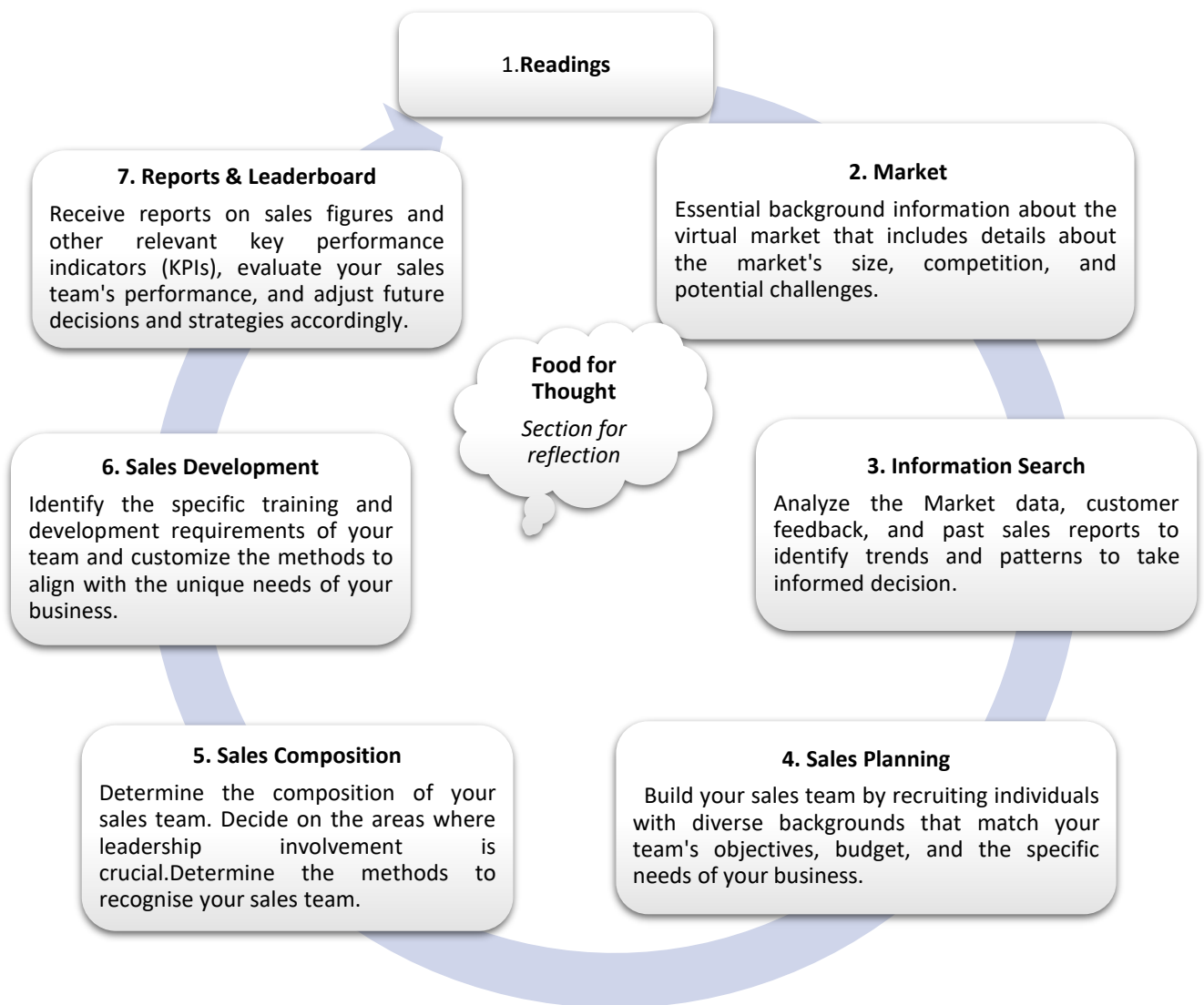


Figure 5 The sequence of decision making

2. Game Arena

2.1 Introduction

This page encompasses information detailing the functioning of the simulation and provides insights into each tab's decision-making.

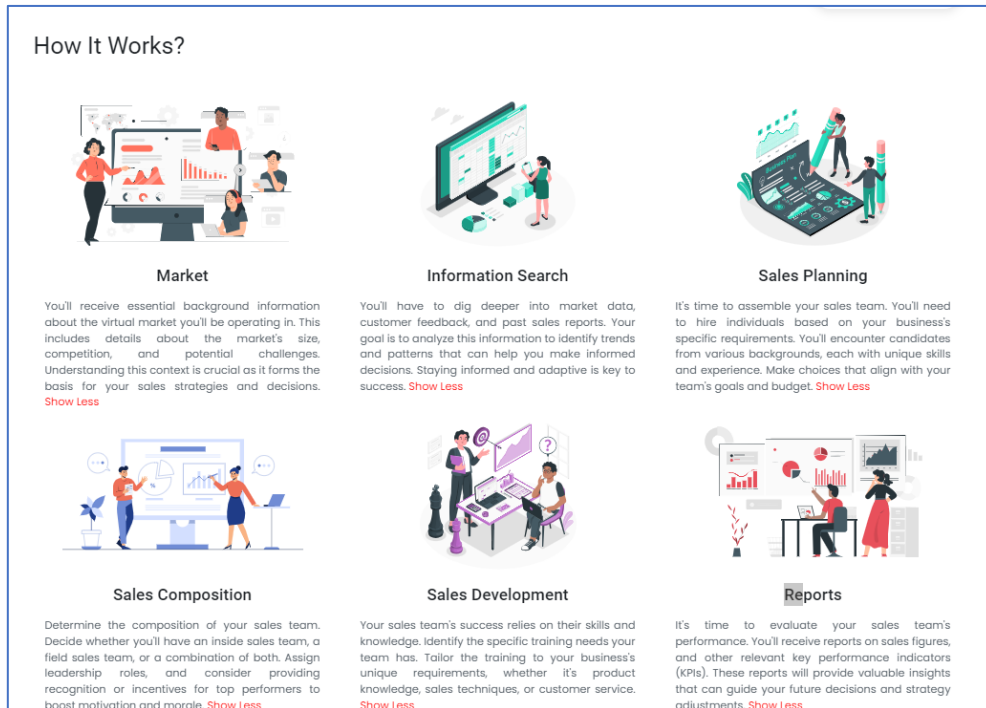


Figure 6 The Introduction Tab

2.2 Food for Thought

This segment provides crucial aspects to consider, offering valuable insights for decision-making.

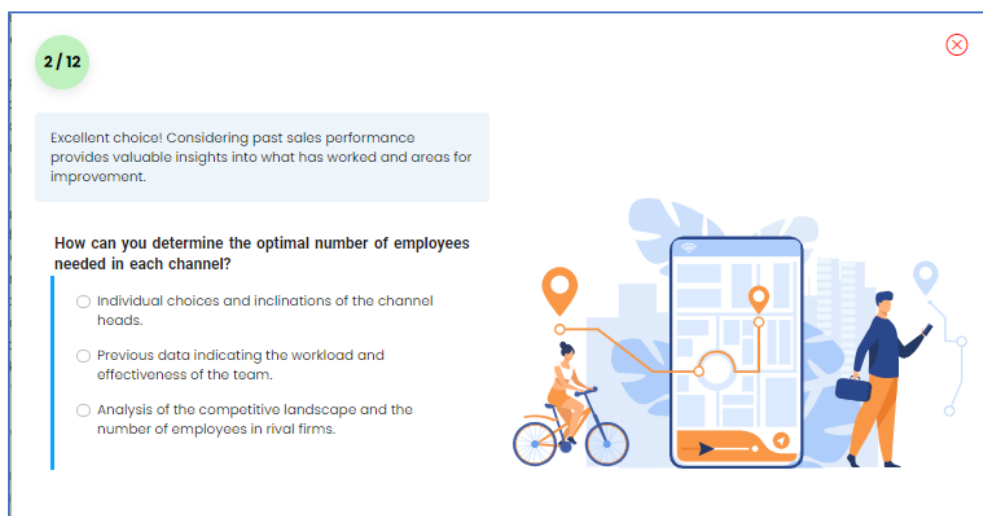


Figure 7 The food for thought Section in the simulation

2.3 Market

Prior to commencing the decision-making process, it is essential to carefully examine the "Market" section. This section offers vital information on case scenario, industry overview and the key parameters to consider when making decisions in each tab.

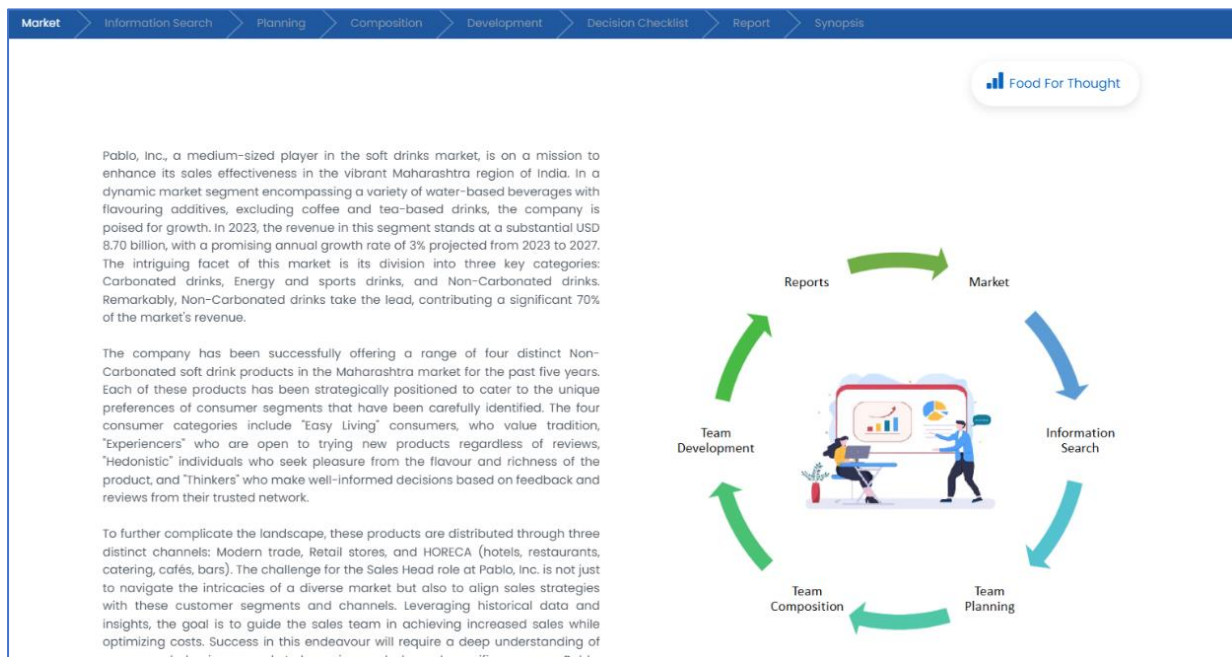


Figure 8 The Market Tab

2.4 The information Search

The information Search tab serves as a comprehensive repository on market dynamics, consumer preferences, and past sales reports to identify trends and patterns to take informed decision.

The information search is organized into three sections:

1. **Market:** This section provides detailed information about the market, including consumer segments and market size.
2. **Products:** This section offers insights into the company's product details, encompassing consumer preferences, individual product prices, past sales figures, and gross margins per product.
3. **Channel:** This section outlines the channel preferences of different consumer segments, channel contribution, and provides details about channel managers.



Figure 9 The Information Search Tab in the Platform

2.5 Planning

I Target & Team

a. Estimated Sales

The first step is to estimate the total product sales that can be generated through various channels. Analyse past sales data to determine the potential sales volume for each channel. Take into account the channel preferences of each segment and assess the performance of each channel to set the sales target accordingly.

b. Number of People

In this section, decisions need to be made regarding the number of personnel to hire across all three channels. Take into account potential attrition for the round as well as the required number of additional personnel needed to achieve the overall sales objective.

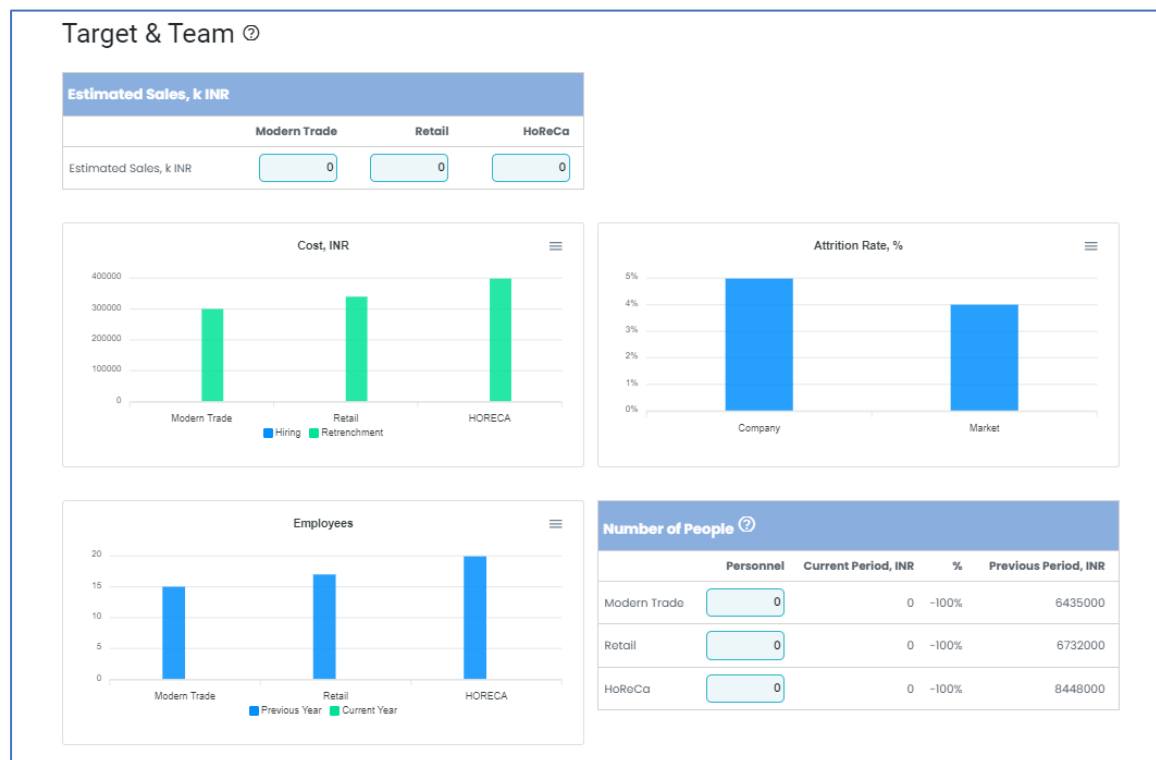


Figure 10 The target & Team decision Area in the Platform

II Compensation

c. Compensation

Participants must decide on the compensation structure for the sales personnel. When designing the compensation, consider factors such as the educational background, motivation to achieve the overall target, and the cost to the company.

d. Sales Force Business Background

In this section, participants need to decide on the balance between team members with business and non-business backgrounds. Considering market dynamics and product preferences, participants must determine the optimal level of background diversity required to achieve the overall sales target and address the unique needs of consumer segment.

e. Bonus % of Total Compensation

To motivate the sales force, participants need to set a bonus percentage. When deciding the bonus percentage, consider how this decision would enhance overall motivation, thus helping achieve the sales target while optimizing costs.

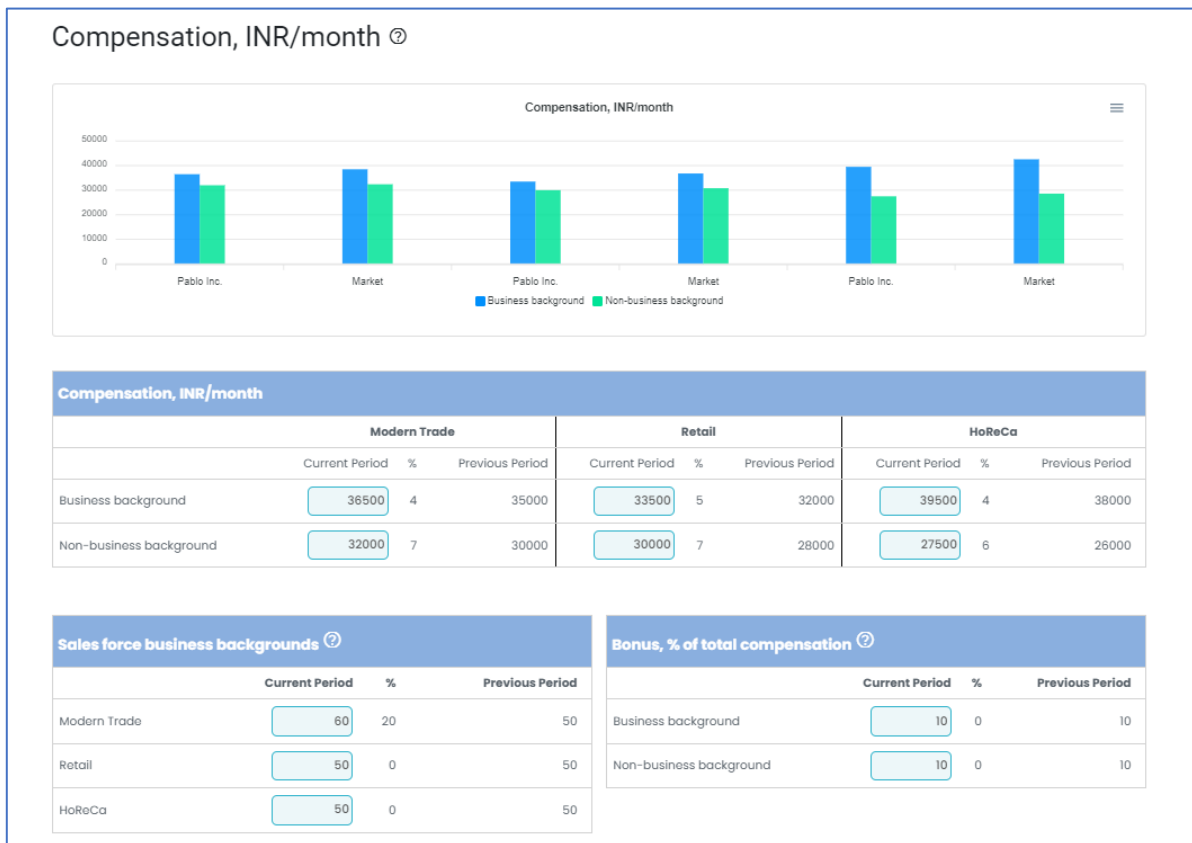


Figure 11 Compensation decision area in the Platform

2.6 Composition

a. Sales Force

In this section, participants must decide on the distribution of the sales force into various roles such as sales representatives, key account managers, and territory sales managers. Considering the differences in the characteristics of each of these roles, participants should assess how this decision will be suitable to your target segment and effectively achieve the sales objectives.

Sales Representatives serving as the front-line salesforce, have a direct impact on all consumer segments. They are instrumental in maintaining relationships with retailers, ensuring product availability, and influencing in-store displays.

Key account managers focus on major customers, such as large retail chains, and have a significant impact on the thinker's segment. They handle larger, more strategic accounts and require a strong understanding of market trends, consumer preferences, and data analytics to effectively cater to this segment. They also impact the Experiencers segment by managing key accounts with a broader consumer base.

Territory sales managers oversee specific geographic regions and coordinate sales representatives within those areas. They play a crucial role in adapting sales strategies to local market conditions. A well-distributed team of territory sales managers can tailor approaches to suit the preferences of each segment within their respective territories. They can adjust strategies to cater to the Hedonistic preferences in some areas and the Easy Living preferences in others.

Sales Force ?



Sales Representatives

Sales representatives, as the front-line salesforce, have a direct impact on all consumer ... [Show More](#)

Moder Trade	25	%
Retail	30	%
HoReCa	35	%



Key Account Manager

Key account managers focus on major customers, which include large retail chains. Their im... [Show More](#)

Moder Trade	30	%
Retail	30	%
HoReCa	25	%



Territory Sales Managers

Territory sales managers oversee specific geographic regions and coordinate sales represen... [Show More](#)

Moder Trade	45	%
Retail	40	%
HoReCa	40	%

Figure 12 Decision on Sales force composition in the platform

b. Sales style

Here the participant can decide what kind of sales style is best suitable for overall channels considering the factors such as how these styles align with the channel head nature, as well as the consumer segment preferences.

Gung Ho is characterized by its zest for quick wins, a straightforward approach, enthusiastic go-getters, looking to close deals with agility. This style aligns well with consumer segments who are open to trying new things.

The Buddy sales style thrives on building trust and cultivating warm, personal relationships with clients. This approach resonates deeply with consumer segments who hold personal connections in high regard, and segments who appreciate the familiarity of a friendly face.

Consultative approach revolves around understanding the unique needs of clients, offering tailored solutions. It tends to strike a chord with consumer segments who make informed decisions based on thoughtful reviews and feedback. Moreover, it is an ideal choice when dealing with products that offer added value or address specific problems.

Sales Style ⓘ



Gung Ho
The Gung Ho sales style is akin to a burst of energy, characterized by its zest for quick... [Show More](#)

Moder Trade	30	%
Retail	35	%
HoReCa	30	%



Buddy
The Buddy sales style thrives on building trust and cultivating warm, personal relationshi... [Show More](#)

Moder Trade	25	%
Retail	35	%
HoReCa	35	%



Consultative
The Consultative sales style is akin to becoming a valued consultant rather than a traditi... [Show More](#)

Moder Trade	45	%
Retail	30	%
HoReCa	35	%

Figure 13 Decision on Sales Style Composition in the Platform

c. Leadership Involvement

In this section, participants must decide in which areas of the sales process leadership involvement is most crucial and necessary. Consider how this decision will impact overall sales effectiveness, streamline processes, improve conversion rates, and help the sales team align their efforts to achieve the company's sales objectives.

Leadership Involvement ⓘ



Involvement in Customers
Leadership's active participation in customer-related decisions can significantly enhance... [Show More](#)



Sales Strategy
Leadership's role in shaping the sales strategy is pivotal. Their guidance and direction c... [Show More](#)



Sales and Marketing Integration
Effective integration of sales and marketing efforts can significantly impact sales. Leade... [Show More](#)



Sales Personnel Support
Leadership's support and investment in sales personnel can boost their motivation and perf... [Show More](#)

Figure 14 Decision on Leadership Involvement in the Platform

d. Recognition

In this section, participants have the opportunity to recognize their employees for their overall performance and teamwork, with the goal of boosting overall team morale, motivation, and performance. When selecting recognition methods, choose options that resonate best with the overall sales team.

Recognition ?

Recognition		
	Estimated Cost, k INR	Current Period
Best Individual Performer	500000	☐
Best Team Effort	600000	☒
Friendliest Coworker	400000	☐

Figure 15 Decision on Recognition for the sales team in the Platform

2.7 Development

a. Sales Development

Participants can decide on the most suitable sales development programs to ensure sustained success. Each of these sales' development programs has different benefits and costs associated with it. Participants can choose any one or more sales development programs.

For example, value-based sales tactics prioritize conveying the unique benefits and value that your products or services bring to the customer. This approach is effective for Thinkers who are driven by informed decisions, resonate with Hedonistic segments looking for maximum value, as well as easy Living segments who appreciate traditional, tried-and-true options.

Sales Development ②

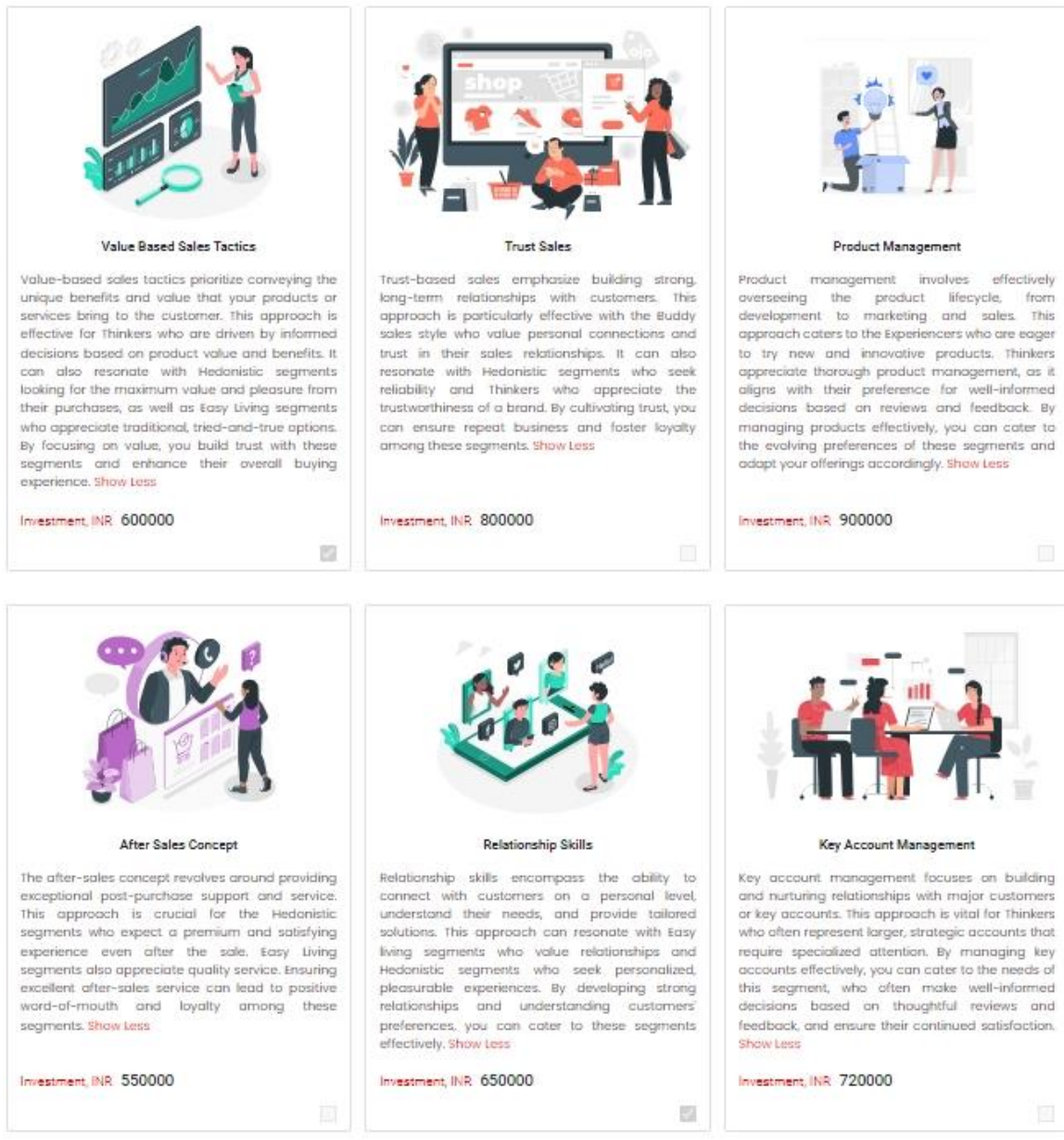


Figure 16 The Sales development decision area in the platform

b. Sales Training

Sales training options aim to improve the sales team's efficiency in handling customers. Participants can choose any of the listed sales training programs, considering the associated cost, benefits, and the overall suitability of the programs for the customer segments.

Sales Training ②



Adaptive Selling Style

The adaptive selling style is characterized by the salesperson's ability to tailor their approach to each customer's unique needs and preferences. This approach is highly effective for the Thinkers segment, as it aligns with their preference for well-informed decisions based on reviews and feedback. It also resonates with Experiencers, who appreciate a personalized approach that caters to their individual tastes. By adapting the sales strategy to the specific requirements of each segment, you can enhance their overall buying experience and increase sales. [Show Less](#)

Investment, INR 750000

☐



Negotiation Style

The negotiation style focuses on reaching mutually beneficial agreements between the salesperson and the customer. This approach is essential for the segments, who value personal connections and trust in their sales relationships. It can also be effective with Hedonistic segments, who appreciate the ability to negotiate for a better deal. By employing effective negotiation skills, you can foster strong relationships and increase customer satisfaction, ultimately leading to higher sales figures. [Show Less](#)

Investment, INR 850000

☐



Closing a Sale

The art of closing a sale is all about sealing the deal and turning potential customers into actual buyers. This approach is particularly effective with the Easy Living segments, who prefer straightforward, no-nonsense sales experiences. It can also resonate with Hedonistic segments, who often seek quick and pleasurable decisions. By employing effective closing techniques, you can encourage prompt decisions and boost sales, especially among these segments. [Show Less](#)

Investment, INR 900000

☒



Efficient Working Method

An efficient working method emphasizes streamlining sales processes and reducing unnecessary steps. This approach is crucial for the Thinkers segment, who appreciate a well-organized and efficient approach to their purchases. It can also resonate with Hedonistic segments, who seek quick and pleasurable experiences. By adopting efficient working methods, you can enhance the buying process, making it more appealing to these segments and ultimately increasing sales. [Show Less](#)

Investment, INR 800000

☐

Figure 17 Sales Training decision area in the platform

c. Sales Process

In this section, participants can select methods to enhance the overall sales process, handle each segment effectively by introducing innovative sales processes, streamlining operations, and reducing waste. The goal is to create superior shopping experiences and ensure a hassle-free shopping journey for customers.

Sales Process ?



Sales Process Innovation

Sales process innovation involves rethinking and enhancing the way sales tasks are performed to achieve better results. This approach is particularly advantageous for the Experiencers segment, who appreciate novel and innovative solutions. Innovating the sales process can lead to the introduction of exciting, unique buying experiences and new products that align with the preferences of these consumers. Additionally, it can be valuable for Thinkers who appreciate well-informed decisions. By leveraging innovative approaches, you can provide them with comprehensive, data-driven sales experiences and thus increase sales effectiveness. [Show Less](#)

Investment, INR 1000000



Process Management

Process management focuses on optimizing and streamlining sales processes to improve efficiency and reduce waste. This approach is beneficial for the Hedonistic segments who value efficient, hassle-free experiences. By managing sales processes effectively, you can ensure that customers enjoy a smooth and enjoyable buying journey, ultimately leading to increased sales among these segments. Process management is also valuable for the Easy Living segment, who appreciate traditional and straightforward methods. By implementing efficient processes, you can cater to their preference for simplicity and reliability, further enhancing their buying experience. [Show Less](#)

Investment, INR 1200000

Figure 18 Sales Process decision area in the Platform

2.8 Decision checklist

The Decision Checklist helps participants review and adjust their decisions before the deadline. Once decisions are finalized, participants can submit them using the Submit option.

Decision Checklist

Round 1
 ▼

Aparna

Sales Planning

Sales Target, Modern Trade	15000
Sales Target, Retail	10000
Sales Target, HoReCa	18000
Personnel, Modern Trade	17
Personnel, Retail	19
Personnel, HoReCa	23
Compensation Modern Trade, Business background	36500
Compensation Modern Trade, Non business background	32000
Compensation Retail, Business background	33500
Compensation Retail, Non business background	30000
Compensation HoReCa, Business background	39500
Compensation HoReCa, Non business background	27500
Bonus %, Business background	10%
Bonus %, Non business background	10%
Sales force Modern trade, Business background	60%
Sales force Retail, Business background	50%
Sales force HoReCa, Business background	50%

Sales Composition

Sales Representative, Modern Trade %	25%
Sales Representative, Retail %	30%
Sales Representative, HoReCa %	35%
Key Account Manager, Modern Trade %	30%
Key Account Manager, Retail %	30%
Key Account Manager, HoReCa %	25%
Territory Sales Manager, Modern Trade %	45%
Territory Sales Manager, Retail %	40%

Figure 19 The decision checklist in the Platform

2.9 Report

- The report section provides the details on the participants' critical thinking abilities in each aspect. It demonstrates how their thought process influenced the outcomes, providing insights into the impact of their decision-making skills.

This section consists of feedback on the performance of the participant based on four metrics.

- Rigour: Consistency throughout the decision-making and recommendation.
- Structuring: Logical approach of gathering and analysing information
- Synthesis: Approach towards interpreting information and making informed decisions
- Business Judgement: Ability to evaluate facts, and consider risks and possible implications when making decisions.

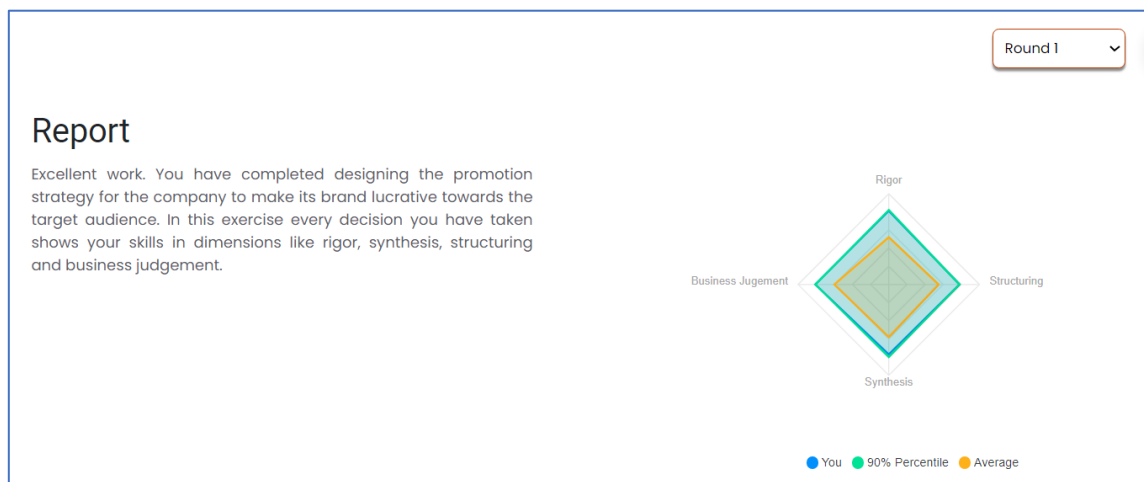


Figure 20 The report section

The report displays the scores achieved based on the decisions made, illustrating the overall sales generated from each channel, segment, and product. Additionally, the report highlights the income statement, breaking down the total revenue, cost, and operating profit. The goal of the simulation is to improve the overall profit and the channel effectiveness percentage.

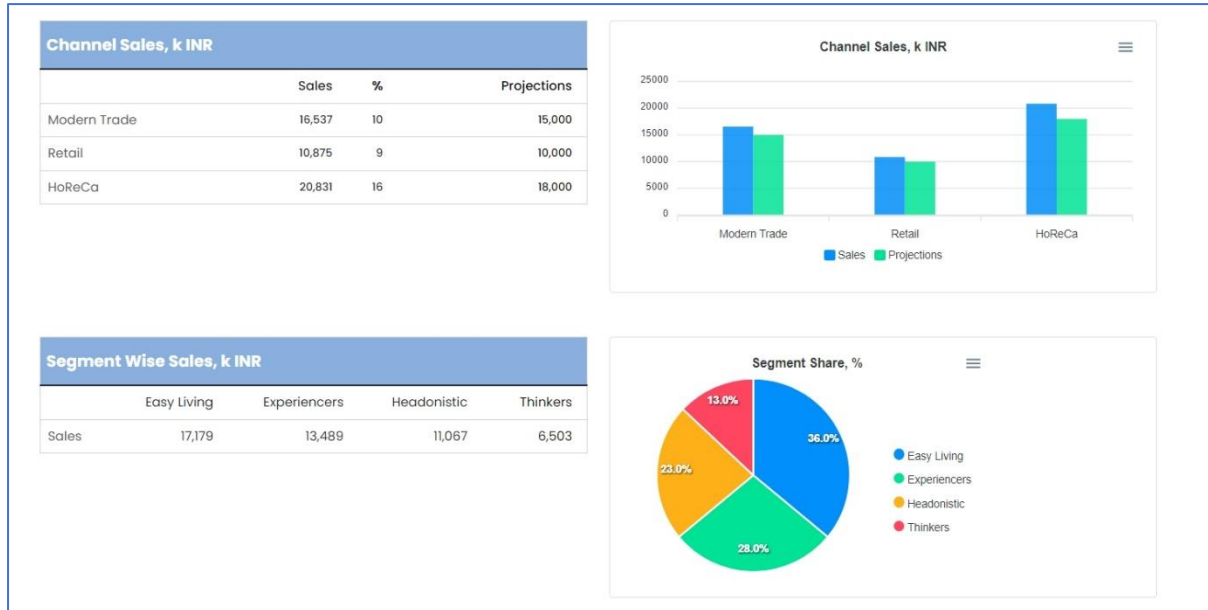


Figure 21 The report section in the platform

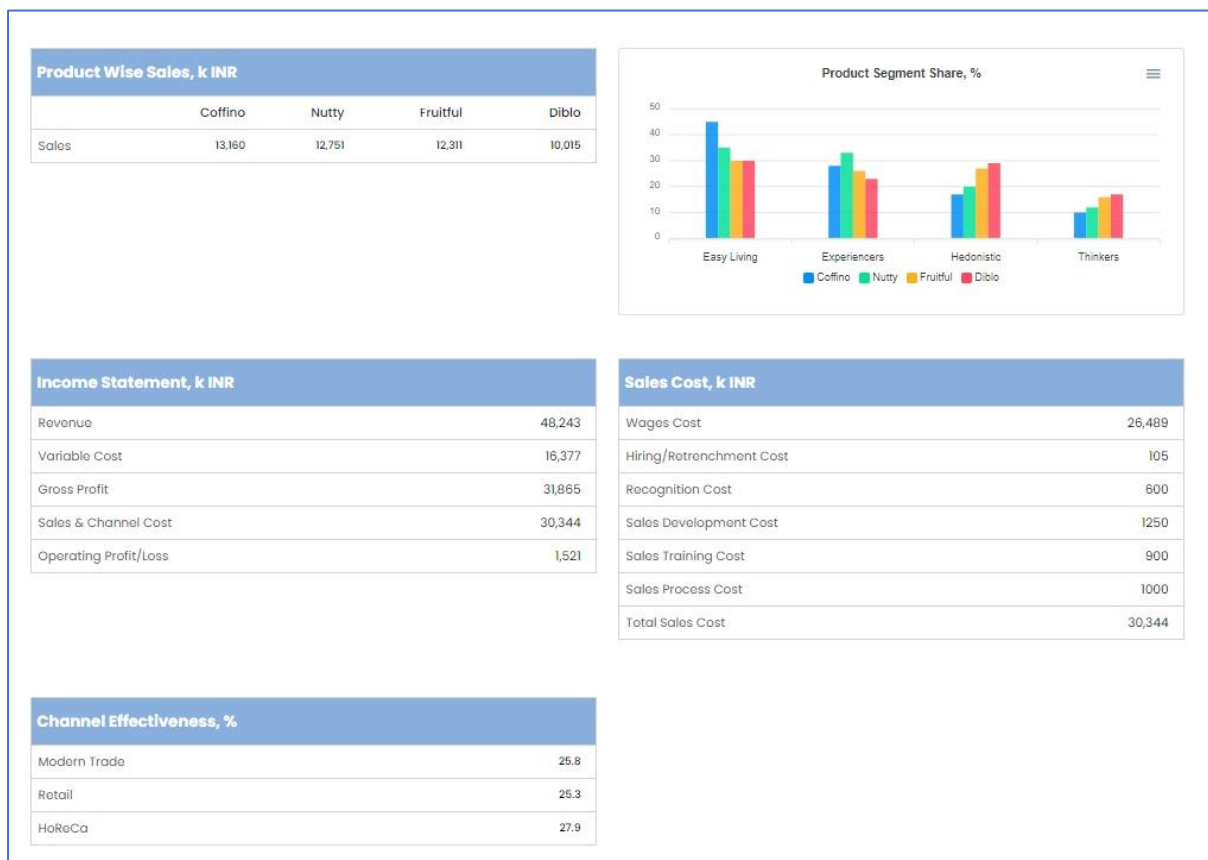


Figure 22 The report section that displays the KPI

2.10 Synopsis

The synopsis section provides a condensed overview of the key decision areas and outcomes, highlighting critical insights and strategic directions taken during the simulation. It offers participants a quick reference point to grasp the essence of their decisions and their impact on various aspects of the business, aiding in holistic understanding and future planning.

Synopsis		Round 1	XLS
Decisions		Sales Cost, k INR	
Sales Target, Modern Trade	15000	Wages Cost	26,489
Sales Target, Retail	10000	Hiring/Retrenchment Cost	105
Sales Target, HoReCa	18000	Recognition Cost	600
Personnel, Modern Trade	17	Sales Development Cost	1,250
Personnel, Retail	19	Sales Training Cost	900
Personnel, HoReCa	23	Sales Process Cost	1,000
Compensation Modern Trade, Business background	36500	Total Sales Cost	30,344
Compensation Modern Trade, Non business background	32000		
Compensation Retail, Business background	33500	Income Statement, k INR	
Compensation Retail, Non business background	30000	Revenue	48,243
Compensation HoReCa, Business background	39500	Variable Cost	16,377
Compensation HoReCa, Non business background	27500	Gross Profit	31,865
Bonus %, Business background	10%	Sales & Channel Cost	30,344
Bonus %, Non business background	10%	Operating Profit/Loss	1,521
Sales force Modern trade, Business background	60%		
Sales force Retail, Business background	50%	Segment Sales, K INR	
Sales force HoReCa, Business background	50%	Easy Living	17,179
Sales Representative, Modern Trade %	25%	Experiencers	13,489
Sales Representative, Retail %	30%	Headonistic	11,067
Sales Representative, HoReCa %	35%	Thinkers	6,503
Key Account Manager, Modern Trade %	30%		

Figure 23 The synopsis tab